

Unequal Job Opportunities and the Measurement of Welfare Inequality

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France, EU-SILC priced through EUROMOD.

Seminar of 17 September. Welfare content is presented under ruling R6; the quantitative decomposition is work in progress.

Question and contribution

Two people with the same tastes and the same wage need not face the same set of jobs.

- How much of measured welfare inequality is attributable to unequal job access and earning opportunities, rather than to preferences?
- What does a model that assumes a common choice set do to that attribution?

Both questions are about a *measure*, not about a policy counterfactual.

The contribution is a structural opportunity set plus a welfare measure defined on it.

- A random-utility, random-opportunity (RURO) model in which *which jobs a household can reach* is estimated, not assumed.
- The Haydar–Maniquet money-metric measure W^1 , applied on the estimated reachable set rather than on a common grid.
- A decomposition architecture that separates preferences from job access, earning opportunities and household endowments and needs.

Third item: the *architecture* is presented today. Its quantitative output is not.

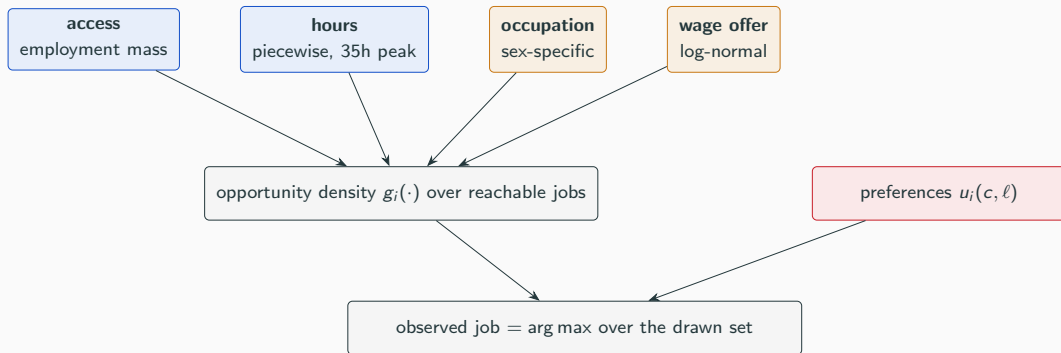
Data and the structural RURO model

France, EU-SILC priced through EUROMOD: 1 540 single-adult and 2 223 couple households.

- Estimation frames: corrected criterion-A panels, S11 model of record.
- Each household: its observed job plus 100 drawn alternatives, every one priced through the tax–benefit system.
- Weights are the survey weights `dwt` throughout.

S11 is the single model of record on these slides. Earlier S8 and R240 frames and their estimates are not shown and are not comparable.

A job is a package; a household draws from its own distribution over packages.



Access and capability are not separately identified; the access factor is their product.

Preferences and the opportunity density are estimated in one likelihood.

$$\Pr(j_i \mid x_i) \propto \exp\{ u_i(c_{ij}, \ell_{ij}) + \log g_i(j) - \log q_i(j) \}$$

u preferences g estimated opportunity density q numerical proposal density, divided out

The proposal correction is what makes the drawn alternatives a simulator for the estimated set rather than the choice set itself.

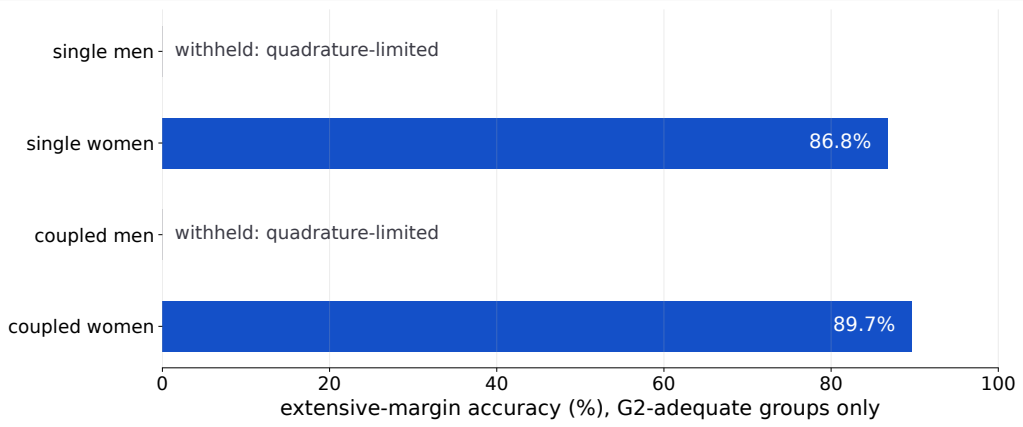
Positive estimates and fit

S11 model of record: 41 free parameters for singles, 47 for couples.

	singles	couples
free parameters	41	47
estimation households	1 540	2 223
objective at $\hat{\theta}$	6253.463	10283.034

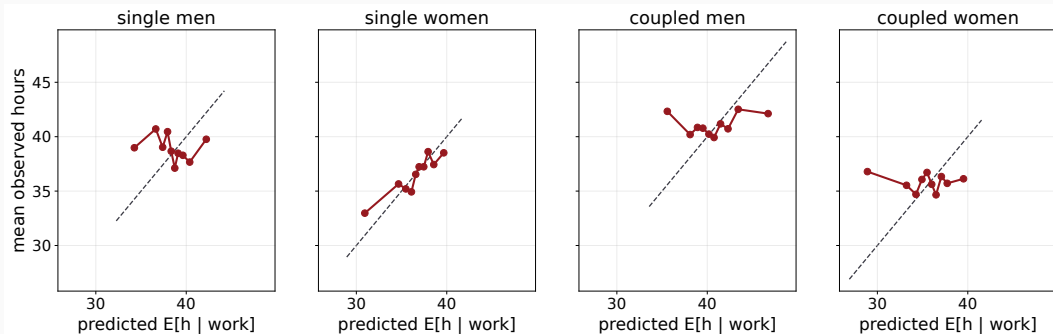
Objectives reproduce exactly under the independent diagnostics evaluator, package commit 55bb0d0.

Extensive-margin accuracy is the one fit statistic that passes the quadrature-adequacy gate.



G2 gate: Monte Carlo s.e. $\leq 0.25 \times$ the sampling s.d. 2 of four groups pass; 2 are quadrature-limited and are withheld, not reported at a worse label.

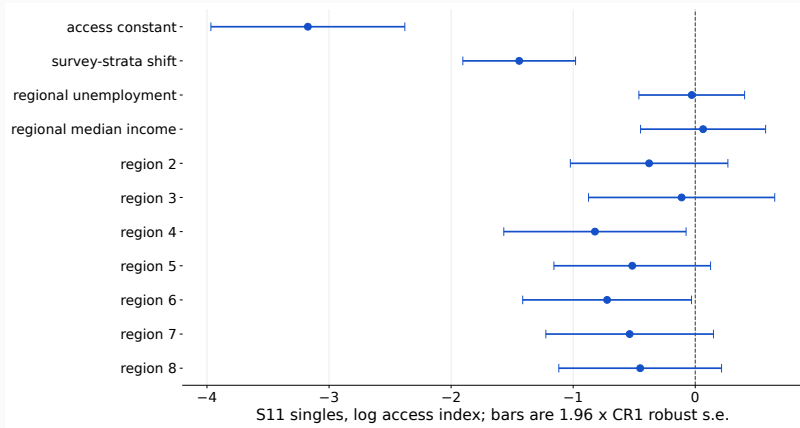
Calibration conditioned on prediction: observed hours against predicted hours, by predicted decile.



quadrature-limited; support audit pending

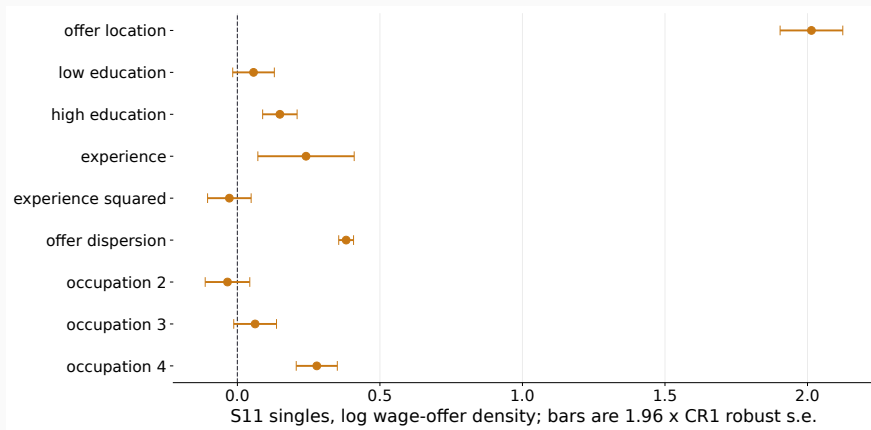
Evidence for heterogeneous opportunities

The access kernel is estimated, and it varies across households.



S11 singles; horizontal bars are $1.96 \times \text{CR1}$ cluster-robust standard errors. Structural and model-conditional; not causal.

So is the earning-opportunity kernel: an offer distribution, not a single wage.



S11 singles; occupation terms shift the offer location. Dispersion $\hat{\sigma} = 0.382$ ($z = 28.7$).

The welfare measure

Haydar–Maniquet W^1 : the consumption at home that would leave the household exactly as well off.

$$W_i^1 = m_i(o; z_i) \quad \text{where} \quad u_i(m_i(o), o) = u_i(z_i)$$

z_i attained bundle o the non-employment state m_i the money metric

Mapping F is the primary empirical implementation (ruling R1). Mapping M is sensitivity only and requires an unidentified intensity parameter; it is not in the baseline.

Under the current specification W^1 coincides with the staying-home equivalent — as a fact about this domain.

$$W_{i,F}^1 = C_i^{\text{obs}} \exp \left[\frac{L_i(j_i^{\text{obs}}) - L_i(o)}{\beta_c} \right]$$

- Inputs: C_i^{obs} , $L_i(j_i^{\text{obs}})$, $L_i(o)$, β_c — nothing else.
- No opportunity density g , no proposal q , no shock ε , no intensity κ .

This is an **empirical-domain coincidence** under log consumption and universally available non-employment. It is **not** the theorem $W^1 = W^4$ in the Haydar–Maniquet theory.

Baseline W^1 -F distribution

Baseline W^1 -F, single adults.

households	1 540
weighted mean	1 435
weighted median	1 320
weighted Gini	0.238
observed workers	1 336
observed non-workers	204

Units: household EUR/month, unequivalised; survey weight dwt. Descriptive baseline; no counterfactual, no decomposition, no causal reading.

Source: MNL/outputs/welfare/baseline_f1_v1/ baseline_f1_full_sample_report_v1.md, commit 6048c9f, independently verified b5550af.

Baseline W^1 -F, couples.

households	2 223
weighted mean	2 496
weighted median	2 356
weighted Gini	0.210
observed workers	2 173
observed non-workers	50

Units: household EUR/month, unequivalised; survey weight dwt. Descriptive baseline; no counterfactual, no decomposition, no causal reading.

Reported separately from singles. No pooled figure: the two samples are separate estimation frames and the welfare unit differs.

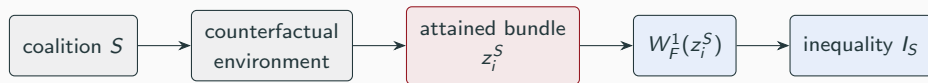
Decomposition architecture

Four operators, one at a time: preferences, job access, earning opportunities, household endowments and needs.

operator	replaces, for every household
P	its preferences by the common reference preferences
A	its job access by the common reference access
B	its earning opportunities by the common reference offer distribution
D	its household endowments and needs by the common reference budget

Operators only. No share, no magnitude, no ordering is claimed on this slide or anywhere in this deck.

The open problem: the baseline is evaluated at the observed bundle, but an operator moves it.



this step is the unresolved one

Two candidate estimands are under design (R5): a realised-bundle route with conditioned latent heterogeneity, and an ex-ante g -computation route. Neither is executed.

Work in progress

Where the quantitative welfare decomposition stands.

- **Settled.** The measure, its reference domain, the measure-correspondence audit, and the descriptive baseline just shown.
- **In design (R5).** The counterfactual attainment operator, and the choice between the two estimands.
- **Open.** The support audit behind the fit statistics, and coverage of the node set at the hours margin.
- **Withdrawn.** Every welfare share previously reported on this project's slides. They were computed on a different functional.

No P/A/B/D share is presented in this deck. R6 permits shares only once the revised F implementation has been executed and independently checked; it has not been.

What I would like from you today.

- Is Mapping F the reference you would want for this question?
- Which counterfactual attainment estimand would you defend?
- What would convince you the access kernel is identified, given that access and capability are not separated?

Thank you.

B1 — Baseline W^1 -F pre-registered checks

check	singles	couples
C1 non-workers, $\max W^1 - C^{\text{obs}} $	0	0
C2 workers, ratio outside $(0, 1)$	0	0
C3 dependency test $(g, q, \varepsilon, \kappa)$	PASS	PASS
C4 MEASURE-MAP-1R worked households	PASS	PASS
C5 indifference identity, $\max \Delta u $	1.8e-15	1.8e-15
C6 guards triggered	0	0

All six checks were pre-registered in the BASELINE-F-1 ruling before execution. C2 violations were to be explained, never clipped; none occurred.

B2 — The G2 quadrature-adequacy gate

group	extensive accuracy	G2 label
coupled women	89.7%	ADEQUATE (ratio 0.17)
single women	86.8%	ADEQUATE (ratio 0.24)
coupled men	—	QUADRATURE-LIMITED, withheld
single men	—	QUADRATURE-LIMITED, withheld

Ratio is Monte Carlo s.e. over sampling s.d.; the gate is ≤ 0.25 . Node bootstrap: 200 replicates over 100 nodes. Simulated bands: 500 outcome vectors at fixed $\hat{\theta}$.

B3 — Authority for what is and is not on these slides

ruling	what it settles here
R1	Mapping F primary; $W^1 = W^4$ is a domain coincidence
R2	W1-EA retired from the baseline; preserved, not repaired
R4	MEASURE-MAP-1R: the measure-correspondence gate
R5	counterfactual attainment: in design, not executed
R6	what this seminar may present
E1	BASELINE-F-1 authorised, executed, independently verified
E2	C^{obs} is the estimated utility's own argument
E3	C^{obs} benchmark: not authorised, not produced

R1–R6: docs/normative/JMP_W1_fork_ruling_v1.md, Appendix A. E1–E3: docs/normative/JMP_W1_BASELINE_F1_authorization_and_Cobs_ruling_v1.md.